Nadeem Patel

Journalism in Practice / 301-0

Jon Marshall

04/21/19

Description Assignment

Word Count: 482

Optimism is in the Air Despite White Sox Losing

By Nadeem Patel

Tim Anderson's walk-up song blasts throughout Guaranteed Rate Field at the bottom of the fourth inning as he strolls to the home plate. After not swinging on three straight pitches on the inside for a 3-0 count, Anderson takes a strike looking and fouls the following pitch for another strike.

"Let's go White Sox!" a little girl shouts from the stands. "You can do it!"

With a full count and Eloy Jimenez leading off on second base, Brad Keller's 93 miles per hour fast ball ricochets off Anderson's bat and soars through the air like a bird. Fans jump to their feet to watch the ball land in the left field stands. The crowd erupts in loud cheers as Anderson flips the bat towards his team's dugout and rounds the diamond behind Jimenez. A scoreless game suddenly changes to 2-0 on the enormous jumbotron as the Chicago White Sox take the lead over the Kansas City Royals.

The lead only makes the day brighter for the attending White Sox fans, who have a rare opportunity to experience a Wednesday afternoon game with 70-degree weather in the middle of April. Fans are forced to remove their jackets and sweaters as Guaranteed Rate Field is lightened up by the sun beaming down. Hot dogs are only a dollar for the time. It is the ideal day for a baseball fan to attend the game, but the stadium is emptier than the local gym after the first month of the year. It could be due to the unusual afternoon time for South Siders or the under .500 record. Regardless, the White Sox are in the middle of a change much bigger than a New Year's resolution as the team builds a winning culture.

Jeff Campbell, 59, is optimistic that the White Sox's rebuilding process will pay off eventually. He sits alone in a crew neck of a color very much like the empty forest green seats that surround him.

Guaranteed Field Stadium with over 40,000 seats continues to have low attendance while the White Sox are in the midst of a rebuild. The recorded attendance for Royals vs White Sox on April 17, 2019 is 14,358 according to Baseball Reference.

“We got some young players that can really help elevate us to a playoff team. If everything works out right, we can be very good, very soon,” says Campbell as the cooling wind blows through his gray and silver hair.

In the meantime, White Sox fans continue to enjoy the occasional dollar hot dogs sold at concession stands, as well as the Dippin’ Dots and cotton candy sold by vendors in the crowd.

The vendors are easy to spot as the bright vests turn them into yellow highlighters. White Sox lose 4-3 at the end of the tenth inning, but the fans get another chance to watch their young talent bloom in a renovated stadium.

Source List

Unofficial Source(s):

Jeff Capmbell, 59, Chicago, Illinois, jeffcampbell.015@gmail.com GOOD TO GET THIS

Website(s):

Baseball Reference, Kansas City Royals at Chicago White Sox Box Score, April 17, 2019, https://www.baseball-reference.com/boxes/CHA/CHA201904170.shtml